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Wine press

1.1.10 Wine press

References:

Hebrew גַּת (gath) JDG 6:11, NEH 13:15, ISA 63:2, LAM 1:15, JOL 4:13

Hebrew יֶקֶב (yeqev) NUM 18:27, NUM 18:30, DEU 15:14, DEU 16:13, JDG 7:25, 2KI 6:27, JOB 24:11, PRO 3:10, ISA 5:2, ISA 16:10, JER 48:33, HOS 9:2, JOL 2:24, JOL 4:13, HAG 2:16, ZEC 14:10

Hebrew פּוּרָה (purah) ISA 63:3

Greek ληνός (lēnos) MAT 21:33, REV 14:19, REV 14:20, REV 14:20, REV 19:15, SIR 33:17

Greek ὑπολήνιον (hupolēnion) MRK 12:1

The Greek word *hupolēnion* in MRK 12:1 refers to the wine trough/vat.

Description and usage:

Man in a winepress (© James Emery - Wikimedia Commons)The wine press was a place for pressing out the juice of grapes for the making of wine (see 9.1 Wine<REALIA:9.1>), vinegar, and grape honey. Ancient wine presses consisted of large treading floors on which the grapes were trampled in order to extract the juice. Depending on the topography, a wine press floor could be larger and shallower than the one depicted in the illustration below. Beneath the wine press floor was placed (or cut out of the rock) a trough or vat into which flowed the grape juice that had just been pressed out.

Translation:

The Hebrew word *gath* usually indicates the treading floor or the entire installation, while *yeqev* is the collecting vat.

A descriptive equivalent of "wine press" may be "place where the juice of grapes was squeezed out" or "… pressed out" (similarly *Parole de Vie* [PV] in MRK 12:1). The Spanish common language translation (SPCL) has "place where wine is made" (JDG 6:11). For "wine trough," translators may use a descriptive phrase, such as "place where the juice of the grapes was collected."

The Hebrew word *purah* may refer to a measure of pressed juice or the act of pressing out the juice in a wine press. In ISA 63:3 most translations render it "wine press." For the first line of this verse the New Jewish Publication Society Version (NJPSV) is more accurate with "I trod out a vintage alone." Good models are GNT "I have trampled the nations like grapes" and CEV "I alone stomped the grapes!"

The Greek word *lēnos* means a depression, hole, trough, or pit. The operation of pressing grapes involved more than one such depression; there was one (in the land of Israel it was a flat surface) in which the grapes were placed and tread, and one or more into which the juice flowed. *Lēnos* can refer to either of these, and it will usually be sufficient to render it something like "pit to crush the grapes in" (CEV; MAT 21:33).

Lēnos is the word used in MAT 21:33. In the parallel passage in MRK 12:1 a different Greek word is used (*hupolēnion*), a word that means a pit which lies below the *lēnos*, that is, a "collection pit" into which the juice flowed from the upper surface where the grapes were crushed. translations render both words the same, usually "wine press" or its equivalent. Some translations (*Traduction œcuménique de la Bible* [TOB], NJB, NRSV, New International Version [NIV], New American Standard Bible [NASB]) use a different word or expression in Mark; for example, NASB has "vat under the wine press."